

ADVANTAGES OR DISADVANTAGES



It is clear from the table that the focus of this chapter is on the advantages or disadvantages of a specific topic. “OR” makes it obvious that there are two sides of the topic, and students choose one of them. What they need to do is to choose one side and stick to that idea and explain their opinions accordingly. In other words, in Pre-intermediate level, students should only write about advantages if they choose that side.



Remember!!

WARNING: Learners should not write about advantages and disadvantages on the same paragraph. Otherwise, they will lose points from both organization and content.

Three basic parts of a paragraph are:

1. Topic Sentence
2. Supporting / Body Sentences (3 Supporting ideas)
3. Concluding Sentence

Model paragraph - 1:

WHAT ARE THE ADVANTAGES OR DISADVANTAGES OF STAYING IN A DORMITORY?

First, have a look at the brainstorming & clustering for the topic. You can brainstorm about advantages and disadvantages separately first and see what you can write about more. Accordingly, focus on one of them. Below is the brainstorming for disadvantages of staying in a dorm.



Remember that you don't have to use all of the ideas, just three. You should also remember to give details to support each of your supporting ideas. More importantly, you need to focus on **ADVANTAGES OR DISADVANTAGES** only!

This is one possible **outline** based on the list above:

Topic sentence: There are many disadvantages of staying in a dormitory.

Supporting idea 1: Students live in poor physical conditions.

Small space and no privacy

Dirty kitchen and toilets

Supporting idea 2: There is a noisy and active life in dormitories.

Loud music coming from next door and visitors or roommates

Exciting activities surrounding students

Supporting idea 3: Students have problems with meals.

Not proper timing of the meals

Options are not available

Concluding sentence: All in all, staying in a dorm has these three disadvantages.

TOPIC SENTENCE		There are several disadvantages of staying in a dormitory.
BODY OF THE PARAGRAPH	SUPPORTING IDEA-1	First of all, students live in poor physical conditions. Since so many students use the bathrooms and kitchens, these places are usually dirty. Therefore, students can suffer from some health issues due to this hygiene problem. In addition, limited space causes privacy problems. Students who live together cannot keep much from each other, because they can see and hear everything they do. For example, they listen to each other when they are on the phone.
	SUPPORTING IDEA-2	Secondly, there is always a noisy and active life in dorms. Because students share the same room with others, friends come and go. Also, there might be some students who stay up all night. This is a serious problem for the ones who like their sleep. Furthermore,

		there is always a game going on in one room. You can hear them having fun and may want to join them. <u>As a result</u> , this can become a distraction from studying. <u>Finally</u> , students can have problems with meals when they stay in a dorm. There is usually a fixed time for each meal in dormitories. <u>For this reason</u> , students who wake up late cannot have breakfast and they stay hungry or eat unhealthy food. What is more, students in some dormitories have limited options for food. Some students have difficulty finding food that they like. <u>For instance</u> , the ones who don't like okra may have to eat soup only with too much bread. <u>In short</u> , staying in a dormitory has these three disadvantages.
	SUPPORTING IDEA - 3	
CONCLUDING SENTENCE		

Model paragraph - 2:

WHAT ARE THE ADVANTAGES OR DISADVANTAGES OF PUBLIC TRANSPORTATION?

Remember the brainstorming & clustering for the topic in Chapter-2 of the writing booklet.

Also, remember that you don't have to use all of the ideas and you need three supporting ideas. You should also remember to give details to support each of your supporting ideas.

This is one possible outline:

Topic sentence: There are many advantages of public transportation.

Supporting idea 1: Details/Examples:

Environmental benefits:

Less air pollution due to carbon emissions

Less land use for roads

Supporting idea 2: Details/Examples:

Economic benefits:

Buses are cheaper than driving

No high parking prices

Supporting idea 3: Details/Examples:

Psychological benefits:

Not stressful (no traffic jam/reading or playing games)

Making new friends



Concluding sentence: In short, public transportation has these three advantages.

TOPIC SENTENCE		There are many advantages of public transportation. The
BODY OF THE PARAGRAPH	SUPPORTING IDEA-1	first advantage is that using public transportation offers some environmental benefits. Public transport causes less pollution than private cars. <u>According to</u> the United States Energy Association, public transportation use in the US reduces the nation's carbon emissions by 37 million metric tons annually <u>because</u> less fuel is needed. <u>In addition</u> , if more people travel by train, tram or bus, there will be fewer cars on the road. <u>Thus</u> , they won't need to destroy nature to build extra roads. The second
	SUPPORTING IDEA-2	advantage concerns the economic benefits of public

topic
OR controlling idea

2. *There are some/three/several advantages of public transportation.*
controlling idea topic

CONCLUDING SENTENCES FOR ADVANTAGES OR DISADVANTAGES PARAGRAPH

In order to write a concluding sentence, one should include a transitional signal and state topic sentence in a different way.

Transitional Signals	Different versions of concluding sentences
In short, In brief, To sum up, In conclusion, All in all,	- these are the three advantages of saying in a dormitory - staying in a dormitory has these/some/several/three disadvantages - there are several/some/several disadvantages of staying in a dormitory.

Note: As can be seen above, there are many ways of saying almost the same thing. For the topic sentence, there are two sentences given. You can use one of them as the topic sentence, and the other one as the concluding sentence of your paragraph. However, you cannot use the same sentence both for topic sentence and concluding sentence.



USEFUL TRANSITIONAL SIGNALS FOR ADVANTAGE/DISADVANTAGE PARAGRAPH

1- TO LIST POINTS:

To start with, / To begin with, / First(ly), Second(ly), Third(ly), Final(ly), <u>OR</u> The first advantage is that Another advantage is that <u>or</u> The second advantage is that The final advantage is that	<u>students live in poor physical conditions</u> CLAUSE <u>there is always a noisy and active life in dorms</u> CLAUSE <u>students can have problems with meals when they stay in a dorm.</u> CLAUSE
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Note: Pay attention to the structure that comes after the linkers in the chart below!

The main / first / second / final / most important advantage	<u>is the psychological benefits of public transportation.</u> NOUN <u>is that using public transportation offers some environmental benefits.</u> CLAUSE <u>concerns the economic benefits of public transportation.</u> V (concerns / deals with) + OBJECT (noun)
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The first / second / last disadvantage of staying in a dorm is	<u>the poor physical conditions</u> NOUN <u>that students live in poor physical conditions</u> CLAUSE <u>living in poor physical conditions</u> V-ing + Object (noun)
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2- TO ADD DETAILS

In addition (to this), Furthermore, Moreover, Also, What is more,	<u>if more people travel by train, tram or bus, there will be fewer cars on the road.</u> CLAUSE
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GIVING EXAMPLES	for example	<u>For example</u> , they listen to each other when they are on the phone.
	for instance	Some students have difficulty finding food that they like. <u>For instance</u> , the ones who don't like okra may have to eat soup only with too much bread.
	such as	-If people travel by subway, they can do many activities <u>such as / like</u> playing games and reading a book.
	like	
GIVING RESULTS	Therefore, , so Thus, As a result,	- <u>Thus</u>, they won't need to destroy nature to build extra roads. - You can hear them having fun and may want to join them. <u>As a result</u>, this can become a distraction from studying.
STATING REASONS	Since Because	- <u>Since</u> so many students use the bathrooms and kitchens, these places are usually dirty. - Students who live together cannot keep much from each other, <u>because</u> they can see and hear everything they do.

PARAGRAPH EXERCISE – 1: Write topic and concluding sentences for each question:

1. What are the advantages OR disadvantages of alternative medicine?

Topic sentence (TS): There are several advantages of alternative medicine.

Concluding sentence (CS): In short, alternative medicine has these three advantages.

2. What are the advantages OR disadvantages of having a pet?

(TS): _____

(CS): _____

3. What are the advantages OR disadvantages of renewable energy?

(TS): _____

(CS): _____

4. What are the advantages OR disadvantages of eating regularly?

(TS): _____

(CS): _____

5. What are the advantages OR disadvantages of distance learning?

(TS): _____

(CS): _____

Write the questions for the topic sentences given below:

6. _____

(TS): There are several disadvantages of nuclear power.

7. _____

(TS): There are many advantages of riding a bike.

8. _____

(TS): There are some disadvantages of group decision-making.

PARAGRAPH EXERCISE-2:

What are the advantages OR disadvantages of living in a city?



1) Put the sentences in order to make the first supporting idea for the question given above.

- a) Since most corporate offices, industries, factories, and government offices are in a city or close to it, there are many job opportunities.
- b) In addition, big international or national companies have their headquarters in cities. People in higher positions work in these places.
- c) The first advantage is that there are wider career options in cities.
- d) Therefore, people can get a promotion and become managers at these headquarters.
- e) People can find a job and make a living more easily in a city.

2) Write the topic sentence and concluding sentence for the same question?

T.S: _____

C.S: _____

3) Write the keywords in the clustering schema given below to map the information given in the second supporting idea.

The second advantage concerns educational facilities. Better schools and universities are often in cities. They provide students with better education with the help of their qualified instructors. Students who attend these schools can find a better job in the future. Furthermore, people can acquire various skills by taking different courses such as language and arts courses at other institutions. These courses can help people to develop personally.

Supporting idea: _____

Supporting detail – 1: _____

Supporting detail – 2: _____

4) Write the last supporting idea for the same question.
